

Dr.-Ing. Christian Herff

Associate Professor

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🌐 neuralinterfacinglab.github.io

Education

- 2012–2016 **Dr.-Ing. Computer Science**, *University of Bremen, Germany, Summa cum laude*
- 2006–2011 **Diploma Computer Science (MSc equivalent)**, *Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, Germany, 1.1*
Best 10% of Graduates
- 2011 **Master thesis**, *Institute for Infocomm Research, Singapore, 1.0*
Funded by Scholarship of Foundation of German Business (SDW)
- 2009–2010 **Bachelor thesis**, *Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi, India*
Funded by Scholarship of Foundation of German Business (SDW)

Work Experience

- Since 2025 **Associate Professor**, *Head of the Neural Interfacing Lab, Faculty for Health, Medicine and Life Science, Maastricht University, The Netherlands*
- 2019–2025 **Assistant Professor**, *Head of the Neural Interfacing Lab, Faculty for Health, Medicine and Life Science, Maastricht University, The Netherlands*
- 2018–2019 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *Department of Neurosurgery, School for Mental Health & Neuroscience, Maastricht University, The Netherlands*
- Nov. 2018 **Visiting Scholar**, *University of Bergamo, Bergamo, Italy*
- Nov. 2017 **Visiting Scholar**, *ASPEN LAB, Old Dominion University, Norfolk, VA, USA*
- 2016–2018 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *Cognitive Systems Lab, Universität Bremen, Germany*
- 2012–2016 **PhD student**, *Cognitive Systems Lab, University of Bremen, Germany, Started at Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, but lab moved to Bremen.*
- 2012 **Visiting Researcher**, *Schalk Lab, New York State Department of Health, Albany, NY, USA*
Funding by International Excellence Fund, Karlsruhe Institute of Technology

Funding and Awards

- 2024 Co-PI in NWO Take-Off: MOVE4Ward (Funding: 40,000€)
- 2024 KNAW: Early Career Award (Funding: 15,000€)
- 2023 IEEE SMC: Early Career Travel Award
- 2022 Kavli Foundation: 'NWB for Brain-Computer Interfaces' (Funding: 10,000€)
- 2020 Google Cloud Platform: 'End-to-End Speech Synthesis from Intracranial EEG' (Funding: 5,000€)

- 2020 Center for Integrative Neuroscience: 'Memory Bias In Decision-making (MEMOBID)' (Funding: 100,000€)
- 2019 NWO VENI Personal Grant: 'DEcoding Speech in SEEG (DEISIS)' (Funding: 249,600€)
- 2018 Postdoc-Initiative Plus: 'Feasibility Study for sEEG-based BCI' (Funding: 9,600€)
- 2018 3rd Price winner BCI award (1,000€)
- 2016 NSF Student travel award für das BCI Meeting 2016 (Funding: 1,100€)
- 2015 Price for best teaching in Computer Science at Karlsruhe Institute of Technology
- 2015 2nd price in Brain-Computer Interface competition at NER'2015 (300€)
- 2013 International Excellence Fund of Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (Funding: 10,000€)
- 2012 Feasibility Study of Young Scientists (Funding: 20,000€)
- 2006-2011 Scholarship of the Foundation of German Business

Selected Invited Talks

- 2015-2026 **Keynote Speaker:** NeuroDecoder, GTec BCI Master Class, BCI Un-Conference
- 2015-2026 **Invited Speaker:** Walk-On Project, UN Science Policy Briefs, CuttingEEG, Telluride Neuromorphic Cognition Engineering Workshop, BrainCom, International Cerebral Palsy Technology Summit
- 2015-2026 **Invited Lecturer:** NASA Research at Langley, Interdisciplinary Kolleg, University of Bielefeld, University of Copenhagen, Utrecht University, Donders Institute, Basque Center for Language Technology
- 2015-2026 **Invited Panelist:** Neuromatch Academy, FutureBody, CogHear Seminar

Service to the Community

- Since 2024 Section Head 'functional Neurosurgery'
- Since 2023 Board Member 'BCI Society'

Conference Organization

- 2024 BCI Society — Chen Institute Joint BCI Meeting December 6-7, 2024, Shanghai, China

Session Organisation

- 2014-2025 13 Session on speech decoding from neural signals organized at the BCI Meeting, SfN, Interspeech and EMBC

Editor

- Since 2017 Editor position for PloS Digital Medicine and several Frontiers journals

Reviewer (selected)

Nature, Neuron, Nature Communications, Nature Machine Intelligence, Nature Reviews Neuroscience, IEEE Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing, IEEE Signal Processing Letters, IEEE Transactions on Biomedical Engineering, IEEE Transactions on Neural Systems and Rehabilitation Engineering, NeuroImage, Journal of Neural Engineering, Frontiers in Neuroscience, Interspeech, IEEE EMBC, IEEE SMC

Media Coverage

Television

2015-2025 TV Globo, RTV, ARD Tagesschau, Arte Xenius and 3Sat Nano

Radio Interviews

2015-2021 BNR, Deutschlandfunk Kultur, 1Live, NDR, RBB, ORG, SWR2

Print Media

2015-2026 Spektrum der Wissenschaft, New York Times, Nature, Science, El Pais, NRC, Wired, Washington Post, The Guardian, de Volkskrant, National Geographic

Teaching

2023- **Course coordinator:** Brain Sciences, Regenerative Medicine and Technology, Health and Digital Transformation

2021- **Lecturer:** Fundamentals of EEG, Closed-Loop Neural Interfaces, Epilepsy Mapping

2012- **Theses:** > 70 supervised Bachelor and Master theses

Supervision

current PhD students

Since 2024 Paul Weger, Maastricht University

Since 2023 Sophia Gimple, Maastricht University

Since 2023 Maria de Araújo Vitória, Maastricht University

Since 2022 Joaquin Vega, Gran Sasso Science Institute

Former PhD students

2021-2025 Sophocles Goulis, Now at University College London

2021-2025 Maxime Verwoert, Still at Maastricht University

2019-2024 Maarten Ottenhof, Now at Brown University

2020-2023 Carlos Valle Araya, Now at Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

2020-2026 **Member of the thesis committee:** KU Leuven, Radboud University, National Institute of Health and Medical Research France, Institute Pasteur, University of Geneva, University of Ulster

Publications

For a full list of publications, see

<https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=n4651jAAAAAJ>